Startup Anthology Brand Guide

Introduction

This guide provides a comprehensive overview of the Startup Anthology brand identity. Following these guidelines ensures consistency across all communications and reinforces our brand recognition. The brand is designed to be professional, modern, and approachable, with a focus on the stories and experiences of early-stage startup employees.

Brand Voice and Tone

Startup Anthology's brand voice reflects its mission to empower the "unsung heroes" of startups. The voice is empowering, supportive, and honest, designed to resonate with startup employees and operators who often lack access to professional financial tools.

Voice Characteristics:

Attribute	**Description**	**Example**
Empowering	Gives confidence and control	"Take control of your financial destiny"
Supportive	Acts as a partner, not a vendor	"Your partner in navigating the complex world of startup finance"
Honest	Transparent and realistic	"See your financial reality clearly, not through rose-colored glasses"
Accessible	No jargon, no gatekeeping	"Financial modeling shouldn't require a finance degree"
Action-Oriented	Direct and practical	"Stop Fighting Your Spreadsheet"
Builder-Centric	Celebrates operators and doers	"Built for the operators, the visionaries, and the unsung heroes"

Core Messaging:

- **Tagline**: "Educate. Equip. Elevate."
- **Mission**: Empowering startup employees and founders with the knowledge, tools, and resources to build successful companies.
- **Positioning**: Championing the underserved contributors in the startup ecosystem.

Tone Guidelines:

- Use "you" and "your" to create a personal connection.
- Frame problems and solutions clearly (problem → solution).
- Focus on benefits and outcomes (clarity, confidence, accessibility).
- Avoid finance jargon and unnecessary complexity.
- Be empathetic about struggles while offering practical solutions.

Target Customer Segments

Startup Anthology serves two primary business models with distinct customer segments.

B2C (Business-to-Consumer) Segments

These individuals seek resources, community, and guidance for their professional journey in startups.

Segment	Needs & Behaviors	Priority
Startup Employees & Managers	Seeking insights to navigate startup culture challenges. Early team members with equity who deserve visibility into financial health. Willing to invest in professional growth tools.	**Primary**
Aspiring Entrepreneurs	Access to a supportive community and mentorship to kickstart their journey. Willing to	Secondary

Segment	Needs & Behaviors	Priority
	pay for networking and mentorship opportunities.	
Freelancers & Contractors	Seeking networking opportunities and skill development resources in the tech startup industry.	Secondary
Startup Enthusiasts	Stay updated on latest trends and innovations in the startup industry.	Secondary

B2B (Business-to-Business) Segments

These organizations need data, insights, and research to aid in hiring, investment, and growth decisions.

Segment	Needs & Behaviors	Priority
Current Entrepreneurs & Founders	Use data insights to match employee types for different roles as the startup grows. Need to model growth, plan fundraising, and present financial projections. Willing to invest in analytics and research tools.	Co-Primary
Angel Investors & VCs	Need data-driven insights to identify promising startups for investment. See value in cultural data for due diligence and portfolio management. Willing to invest in analytics and research tools.	Secondary

Additional Audience Segments

Segment	Description
Early-Stage Operators	COOs, heads of finance, and operations leads who manage day-to-day financial planning for growing companies.
Small Business Owners	Entrepreneurs across industries (SaaS to real estate) who need structured financial forecasting.
Pre-Revenue Builders	Teams still validating their idea who need to model runway, burn rate, and projected growth.

Color Palette

The Startup Anthology color palette is built on a foundation of neutral tones, accented with a distinctive gold to convey value, quality, and achievement. This combination creates a professional and timeless look.

Color	HEX	RGB	CMYK	Usage
White	#FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	0, 0, 0, 0	Primary background color, text on dark backgrounds.
Black	#000000	0, 0, 0	0, 0, 0, 100	Primary text color, dark backgrounds.
Gray	#999999	153, 153, 153	0, 0, 0, 40	Secondary text, subtle UI elements, and borders.
Startup Anthology Gold	#BB935B	187, 147, 91	0, 21, 51, 27	Accent color for highlights, calls-to-action,

Color	HEX	RGB	CMYK	Usage
				and key information.

Typography

Our typographic system is designed to create clear hierarchy, improve readability, and add visual interest. Each typeface has a specific role to ensure a consistent and professional appearance.

Purpose	Typeface	Weight/Style	Source
Title	Lato	Bold Italic	Google Fonts
Subtitle	Montserrat	Regular Italic	Google Fonts
Heading	League Spartan	Regular	Google Fonts
Subheading	HK Grotesk	Regular	Google Fonts
Section Header	Gotham	Regular	Adobe Fonts
Body	Montserrat	Regular	Google Fonts
Quote	Lora		Google Fonts
Caption	Montserrat		Google Fonts

Note on Font Licensing: While most fonts are available via Google Fonts, HK Grotesk and Gotham may require licensed access for commercial web projects. Recommended open-source fallbacks include Inter or Work Sans for HK Grotesk, and Proxima Nova or Montserrat for Gotham.

Logo Usage

The Startup Anthology logo is a key element of our brand identity. It is available in several configurations to suit different contexts and layouts. Consistent and correct application is essential.

Logo Variants

Variant	Description	When to Use
Vertical Badge (Icon Only)	The standalone rocket icon badge without any text.	Ideal for compact spaces, social media profile pictures, and application icons where the brand is already established.
Vertical Badge + Wordmark	The icon badge is positioned above the "STARTUP ANTHOLOGY" wordmark.	This is the primary logo and should be used in most applications.
Vertical Badge + Gold Wordmark	The icon badge with the wordmark in Startup Anthology Gold.	Reserved for premium materials or instances where special emphasis is desired.
Horizontal Badge + Wordmark	The icon badge is positioned to the left of the "STARTUP ANTHOLOGY" wordmark.	Best for wide layouts such as website headers and banners.

Color Application

Toensure legibility,thelogo color must contrast sufficiently with the background.

- Use the **black badge** and wordmark on light backgrounds (e.g., white, light gray).
- Use the **white badge** and wordmark on dark backgrounds (e.g., black, dark images).
- The **gold wordmark** variant is versatile and can be used effectively on both light and dark backgrounds.

Bundled Logo Assets

The followinglogofilesareavailable for use. Please select the appropriate file based on the intended background color and layout.

Vertical Badge (Icon Only)

Background	File Name
Light	SALogo_VBadge-Black.png
Dark	SALogo_VBadge-White.png

Vertical Badge + Wordmark

Background	File Name
Light	SALogo_VBadge-BlackSTARTUP_ANTHOLOGY.png
Dark	SALogo_VBadge-WhiteSTARTUP_ANTHOLOGY.png

Vertical Badge + Gold Wordmark

Background	File Name
Light	SALogo_VBadge-BlackSTARTUP_ANTHOLOGY-Gold.png
Dark	SALogo_VBadge-WhiteSTARTUP_ANTHOLOGY-Gold.png
Black (Special)	SALogo_VBadge-BlackSTARTUP_ANTHOLOGY-GoldBackgound-Black.png

Horizontal Badge + Wordmark

Background	File Name
Light	SALogo_HBadge-BlackSTARTUP_ANTHOLOGY.png
Dark	SALogo_HBadge-WhiteSTARTUP_ANTHOLOGY.png

Brand Focus

To maintain a clear and consistent brand message, please adhere to the following principles when creating content and materials for Startup Anthology.

1. **Target Audience**: Prioritize **startup employees and managers** as the primary audience, with founders as a co-primary focus. Content and messaging should resonate most strongly with the experiences of those working within early-stage companies.

2. **Brand Exclusivity**: All materials must exclusively feature Startup Anthology branding. Do not include or co-brand with other entities such as HaulConnect or Make Equity Accessible.

3. **Strategic Use of Gold**: The Startup Anthology Gold color should be used sparingly and strategically as an accent. Its purpose is to draw attention to key information, highlight calls-to-action, and add a touch of premium quality. Avoid using it for large blocks of text or backgrounds.

4. **Typographic Hierarchy**: Consistently apply the defined typographic system. The clear hierarchy of titles, headings, and body text guides the reader through the content and ensures a professional, polished presentation.

5. **Voice Consistency**: Maintain an empowering, supportive, and accessible tone across all communications.

6. **Mission Alignment**: Document and share the "never-told" stories of early-stage employees and middle-management.